is derived from the Latin word "superanus" which means "supreme". In a traditional understanding, the characteristics of sovereignty are absoluteness, permanence, universality, indivisibility, exclusiveness, and inalienability.

The father of the modern theory of sovereignty was ***Jean Bodin*** (1530 – 1597) a French political thinker. According to ***Harold J. Laski***, "It is by possession of sovereignty that the State is distinguished from all other forms of human association". Human Association would mean anything from family, society and even voluntary organization similar kinds through which humans identify themselves together.

DO YOU KNOW?

- Can there be a Permanent Chief Minister or Permanent Prime Minister in a democracy?
- Find out the maximum term of office, a person can be elected as President of the United States of America? Why?



ACTIVITY

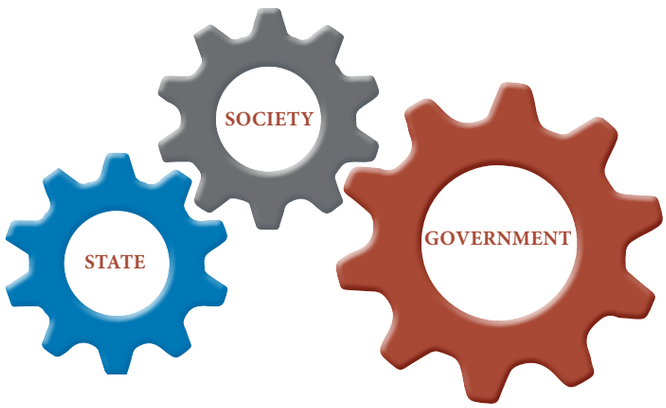
Look at the newspaper advertisement given by the Government of India. Answer the following questions:

- What do you understand by the word 'State'?
- List five ways in which you think that the government affects your daily life.
- Why do you think the State needs to make rules for everyone in the form of laws?

2.3 Society, state and Government

Society, State and Government – How are they interrelated?

Historically when humans evolved from hunters and gatherers to a settled community, they started to produce goods. Group of families constituted a community and a group of communities constituted what we call as a society. Individuals for their emotional need that is often reciprocal lived in the family.



Families came together under the umbrella of the community for a greater objective of security. The communities so formed made a higher level of organization called society.

When society degenerates, it has a consequent effect on the communities and ultimately upon its constituent families and each and every individual would lead to suffering. Thus, it was, for this reason, humans came together, guided by reason felt the need of the State.

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